

Child Restraint System and Safety Seats

You must secure children with a federally-approved child passenger restraint system or safety belt. The requirements depend on the child's height and age.

- **Children who are under 2 years old, under 40 pounds, and under 3 feet 4 inches tall:** Secure in a rear-facing child passenger restraint system.

NOTE: A child in a rear-facing child passenger restraint system may not ride in the front seat of an airbag-equipped vehicle.

- **Children who are under 8 years old, or who are less than 4 feet 9 inches tall:** Secure in a child passenger restraint system in a rear seat. In some cases, children under 8 years old may ride in the front seat of a vehicle in a federally-approved child passenger restraint system. They may ride in the front seat if:
 - There is no rear seat.
 - The rear seats are side-facing jump seats.
 - The rear seats are rear-facing seats.
 - The child passenger restraint system cannot be installed properly in the rear seat.
 - All rear seats are already occupied by children 7 years old or younger.
 - Medical reasons prevent the child from riding in the back seat.
- **Children who are 8 years old or older, or at least 4 feet 9 inches tall:** May use a properly secured safety belt that meets federal standards.

Your local law enforcement agency or fire department can check the installation of your child passenger restraint system. As your child grows, check that the child passenger restraint system is the right size.